

Helix Reader

Turning digital reading from passive scrolling into active learning.

FOCUS MODE

VOCAB LOCK

TTS

XP + BADGES

TEAM NAME

Binary Ghosts

Problem Statement

Digital reading gives us access — but not necessarily understanding.

Long-form digital content encourages skimming, vocabulary gaps, fragmented workflows and distraction. Readers often jump between a book, dictionary, text-to-speech tool and revision system instead of staying inside one focused environment.

SKIMMING

Fast scanning and eye-regression make sustained attention harder, especially in long-form digital text.

VOCABULARY

A word lookup is useful in the moment, but it is easily forgotten because it is disconnected from revision.

FRAGMENTATION

Reading, lookup, audio, notes and progress tracking are commonly spread across separate tools.

Our Solution

Helix Reader turns the reader interface into a learning system.

Rather than requiring the reader to manage multiple tools, the experience integrates support directly into the reading flow.

01 FOCUS

Guided reading views and pacing reduce visual wandering and encourage deliberate reading.

02 UNDERSTAND

Instant dictionary support, vocabulary capture and narration help readers resolve friction immediately.

03 RECALL

Saved vocabulary, quizzes, XP, badges and progress history turn reading into an active loop.

04 IMPROVE

Accessibility controls and reading insights help users build a sustainable reading habit.

Key Features

Focus Mode

Guided line/reading pacing to reduce visual distraction.

Vocabulary Lock

Save difficult words directly while reading for later revision.

Text-to-Speech

Listen to content while maintaining a reading-focused workflow.

Accessibility

Typography, spacing and reading controls designed for different reading needs.

Gamification

XP, streaks and badges provide visible progress and motivation.

Reading Insights

Track habits and progress instead of treating every session as isolated.

User Journey

From opening a book to remembering what was read.



THE HELIX LOOP Focus → Understand → Recall → Progress → Better next session

Technical Approach

FRONTEND

HTML • CSS • JavaScript Responsive reading interface Interactive controls Focus and accessibility views Reading progress UI

BACKEND / UTILITIES

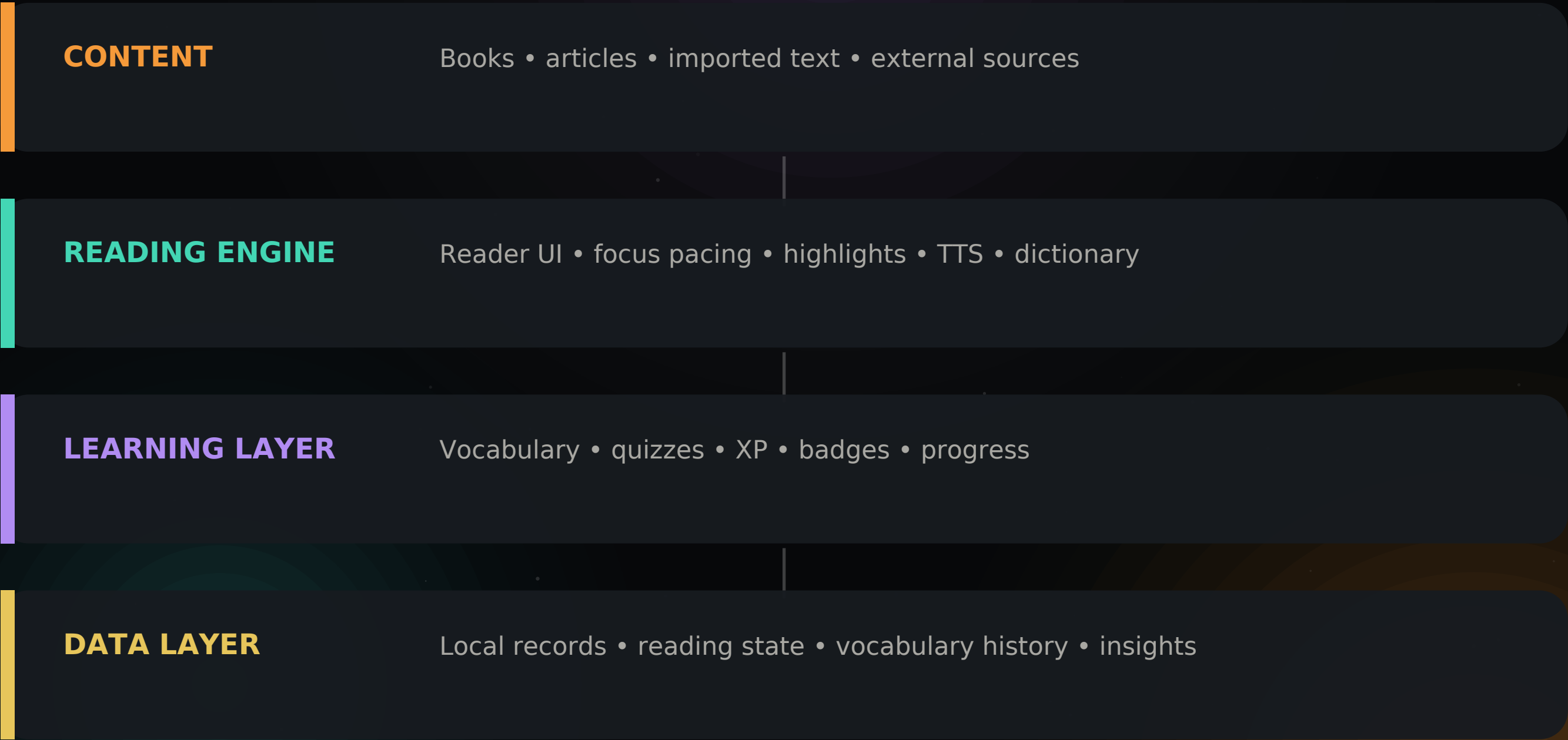
Python NLP utilities Text processing Reading-support logic Streamlit dashboard / utilities

DATA + DEPLOYMENT

SQLite User/progress state Vocabulary records Reading history Static web deployment + project repository

Methodology: modular features → reusable reading components → progressive enhancement

System Architecture



The architecture keeps learning features around the reading experience — not in a separate app.

Challenges & Risks

ACCESSIBILITY WITHOUT CLUTTER

Controls need to remain discoverable without making the reader interface overwhelming.

STATE & PROGRESS

Reading position, vocabulary, highlights and achievements must stay consistent across sessions.

EXTERNAL CONTENT

Different sources and formats can behave differently; fallbacks are needed to keep the workflow simple.

PERFORMANCE

Search, audio, NLP utilities and interactive UI should remain responsive as usage grows.

AI / NLP RELIABILITY

Supportive outputs need safe fallbacks so uncertain results do not interrupt reading.

ENGAGEMENT BALANCE

Xpand badges should reinforce reading habits instead of becoming another distraction.

Impact, Benefits & Future Scope

FOR READERS

A calmer reading workflow with immediate support, vocabulary capture, narration, accessibility controls and visible progress.

FOR EDUCATORS

A foundation for measurable reading habits, comprehension checkpoints and future learning-dashboard integration.

FOR INSTITUTIONS

A modular reading platform that can grow into LMS integrations and broader digital-learning workflows.

Phase 1

Universal Web Clipper

Bring guided pacing to web articles.

Phase 2

personalised audio

Multi-speaker, higher-fidelity narration.

Phase 3

INSTITUTIONAL LMS

Connect progress to institutional dashboards.

RESEARCH • PROTOTYPE • OPEN INNOVATION

Thank you.

Read slower. Understand deeper. Remember longer.

<https://hardik-arora.github.io/helix-reader/>

Research / integration references

Project Gutenberg • Open Library • Google Books • Internet Archive • Helix Reader repository

